



Essay Writing

Descriptive Test

An essay has three main parts viz. Introduction, Body and Conclusion. But two more points are important for writing a good essay. Hence, following five steps should be kept in mind while writing an essay:

1. Before Introduction
2. Introduction
3. Body
4. Conclusion
5. After Conclusion – Proofreading

1. BEFORE INTRODUCTION

a. Choosing a topic

- Analyse the topics given and choose a topic about which you are most comfortable with. You need to see comfort in two aspects:
 1. Knowledge wise
 2. Passion wise

Suppose out of 5 given topics you are comfortable with 2 topics, need to do is ask yourself which topic you are passionate about. express in a lucid manner if you are emotional about something.

- Once you decide the topic, give at least 5 minutes time to structure the essay.

b. Structuring / Planning your essay

- Planning helps you organize your ideas and structure before you write, saving you time and helping you write a clear essay.
- Initially don't focus more on how you will start. (Otherwise wasting a lot of time on introduction part only.)
- Just broadly think about the topic.
- Note all the points coming to your mind and then put the points noted in three boxes i.e. Introduction, Body and Conclusion.

- Try to include the most important and valid points in either introduction or conclusion depending on the nature of the points. But don't be rigid, if you feel that on a particular topic you have a better way to begin the essay, you can write those points in the initial parts of the the body.

For this you may take help of 'what', 'why' and 'how'. So, Points answering 'What' will be in the introduction Box, 'Why: in the first part of the Body, it will include the challenges related to the topic and "How' in solutions to the problem discussed.

Visualise the complete essay before you start writing it. It would be great if you are able to see the conclusion before writing the introduction. Accordingly, you add some points in the introduction part.

• **INTRODUCTION**

- Any appropriate Quotation/ Anecdote / Observation related to the topic if you remember. But don't begin with the quote only for the sake of using a quote. Use it only if it is appropriate.
- What is? (HDI/ Financial Inclusion / UBI / Fake news) You can begin with the dictionary meaning of the word also.
- But the best way is if you are able to use the facts and information on the topic as teaser, as it may arouse curiosity and the examiner would like to read what is next in the essay. You may start the introduction by providing a data and ask the question, what does this data indicate? And then answer this question with your view point. This unconventional approach will attention of the examiner.
- The introduction part should tell the examiner about your stand on the topic.

2. **BODY**

This will comprise multiple paragraphs and it is the part where you can include examples, data, comparisons, etc to emphasize on your stand and persuade the reader towards your opinion.

You may frame your essay in any of the following ways:-

- Agree / Disagree with the statement given in the topic
- Discuss several (two or more) Opinions, few of which may be given in the topic

- Discuss the Causes of the issue mentioned in the topic
- Mention the Problems related to the topic and Solutions for it
- Discuss the Advantages and Disadvantages of the policy/step mentioned in the topic

It can be further made interesting :

- by including views of prominent personalities
- How similar problems in other parts of the world have been solved
- Asking questions
- Justify your opinion with arguments, discussion, examples, problem outlining, proposing possible solutions and supporting your position.

3. CONCLUSION

- Very important part of your essay as you are leaving an impression here to the examiner
- Try to summarise the points you have already discussed and try to give the final and closing statements based on the points you have written in the Body.
- Be specific, since you are concluding, if you are discussing solutions to a problem given in the topic, you should be very clear in your mind what should be done.
- End the essay on an optimistic note.

4. AFTER CONCLUSION: PROOFREADING

- Don't forget to proofread your essay and correct the spelling and grammatical mistakes, if any.
- You can also rearrange some sentences and add some conjunctions wherever required to make your essay flow.